

Tally 6.3

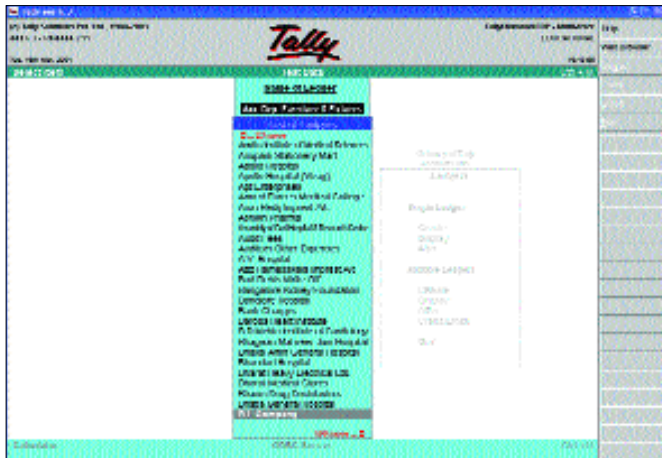
No software can beat Tally in terms of ease of use. Its two-button combination of **[Enter]** and **[Esc]** takes you to micro-level details as well as brings you out of them. Though Tally's learning curve is exceedingly small, novices might still get stuck at the company creation process or viewing trial balance. Initially, you'll find yourself referring to the help files within the software quite frequently. However, once you master the hotkeys, you won't need to do all that. No documentation is bundled.

“Accountants’ best friend; control drawbacks unresolved”

There's a pre-defined set of groups, but no templates for charts of accounts while creating a new company. However, it does allow you to enable or disable the inventory module while creating accounts.

It has some great new features such as e-mailing and uploading the data directly from the software. It also has support for budgeting, cost centre, VAT, excise, cash flow, funds flow, aging analysis, etc. Some may feel that having a facility to enter back-dated entries is a plus point. However, corporates reckon that it might increase the chances of corruption. Such entries are allowed by default, but you can restrict the user by specifying the necessary permissions in the security control. You can restrict the rights of the user in the security control by using create, alter, create/alter, etc. Around nine different types of ratios are provided by the software for analysis by accountants.

Thus features-wise, Tally is right up front. It has a horde of them that might take you some time to master. Indeed, it's definitely a lot more than a simple accounting package.



Price: Softlock—Rs 9,900; unlimited network version—Rs 45,000
 + User-friendly, advanced features such as budgeting, cost centre, etc., reports such as aging analysis, peak balance, etc.
 – Back-dated entries

Wings 16

Wings is one of the crown holders in our previous tests, and this time too, it stood up to the test. What first grabs your attention is the neat menu layout with dividers to group and sub-group functionalities.

There's almost no feature that Wings lacks. Wings presents a range of new features like a History file, pending bills, year-ending process, peak balance, etc. The History file feature is of utmost importance, as it can reconstruct the entire database if disaster should strike. The History file feature takes incremental backup. If you have offices in multiple locations, you can have a central database repository where all the other locations would send the incremental data to, by e-mail. This would then be used to sync the central database with the location databases.

Wings provides ways whereby users can be restricted on a field-by-field basis.

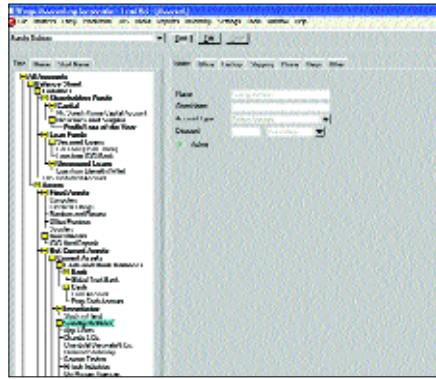
“ Good management tool with a plethora of customisable reports. Economical ”

What helped Wings retain the crown were its reports. It has a whole gamut of reports, right from basic trial balance to advanced reports such as reorder report, sales tax report, excise duty report, etc. Each report is entirely customisable. In the collection of reports, some reports are based on new concepts such as transaction analysis, trend analysis, deleted voucher report, etc. The bulk import facility provides a way to easily import large volumes of data.

An example of how feature-rich the software is, is that the

interest calculation feature for late payments has been extended to a slab architecture whereby, as the payment gets more and more delayed, different interest rates can be applied.

Another new feature is the peak balance report, which not only shows the peak balance, but also the date upon which the peak balance occurred, for both debit as well as credit.



Wings Accounting starts at Rs 5,900 (Wings Accounting SB), with Inventory at Rs 12,900. The multi-user pack comes for an additional Rs 10,000. With each copy of Wings Accounting, you get a free copy of ACT!5, and contact management software worth about Rs 6,000.

Price: Wings Accounting SB Rs 5,900; with Inventory Rs 12,900
 + Easy to handle, provides peak balance, exceedingly good year ending routine
 – None

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Performance	    
Features	    
Ease of Use	    
Overall	    

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